

Vedas: Vid = to know, vision, to exist

- The Vedas, meaning “knowledge,” are the oldest texts of Indian Civilization
- It is written in Sanskrit between 1500 and 500 BCE
- Vedas are more than 3000 years old, they are considered Shruti (that which was ‘heard’ or revealed to ancient sages).
- It was taught and memorised – for it was a combination of script and chanting = UPASANA (practice)
- Secondly it had different levels and only those who qualified for higher level would have access to the knowledge.
- Over the years, certain portions of the hymns were written and only a few hymn / verses are now available.

- The essence of the Vedas is to propound that
 - (a) Energy has manifested into Matter & will finally convert into Energy
 - (b) Beings are part of the cosmic creation and destruction
- **Sage Veda Vyasa** –compiled the Vedas and recorded it.
- He categorized the Vedas into FOUR parts and taught it to his students – which became FOUR schools of study
 - **Rig-Veda** - Rishi Paila and subsequently his students
 - **Yajur Veda** – Rishi Vaishampayana and subsequently his students
 - **Sama Veda** – Rishi Jaimini and subsequently his students
 - **Atharva Veda** – Rishi Sumantu and subsequently his students

EACH VEDA has FOUR SUB-SECTIONS

1. Samhita – Introduction , Hymns or mantras
2. Brahmana – Theoretical Details of the Different Procedures
3. Aranyaka – Experimental methods and inferences. Explains the symbols used including mudras during the performance of worship
4. Upanishad – Summary, Philosophical Treatises

Rig Veda – Rishi Paila : The Veda of Hymns

Among all the four Vedas this is the most voluminous. It describes the fundamental aspects or the essence of the universe.

Hymn are related to Earth, Water, Fire, Air, Ether – Elements of Nature – how they combine and manifest in various forms. It is highly mystical form and requires correct understanding.

Hiranyagarbha Sukta was revealed to Sage Prajapathi Paramesti, Literal meaning is “Golden Womb”,

हिरण्यगर्भः समवर्तताग्रे भूतस्य जातः पतिरेकासीत् ।
स दाधार पृथ्वीं ध्यामुतेमां कस्मै देवायहविषा विधेम ॥

hiraṇyagarbhaḥ samavartatāgre bhūtasya jātaḥ patirekāśīta |
sa dādharma pṛthvīm dhyāmutemām kasmai devāyahaviṣā vidhema |

Golden womb – described as the cosmic womb floating in the void or primordial source from which the entire universe originated.

It symbolizes birth of creation, the seed of all existence.

This explanation matches with the Big Bang Theory.

Purusha Sukta – literally means the PRIMAL BEING. It talks about original or fundamental form of existence, something connected to the earliest state of life

ए॒तावान॑स्य॒ महि॒मा । अतो॑ ज्या॒याग॑श्च पू॒रुषः॑ ।
पादो॑ऽस्य॒ विश्वा॑ भू॒तानि॑ । त्रि॒पाद॑स्यामृतं दि॒वि ॥

The whole manifested universe is His splendour; However, the Purusha is greater than this. All the beings form only a quarter of (part of) Him. The three-quarters part of His, which is eternal, is established in the spiritual domain.

Rig Veda:

(A) Samhita: Hymns related to the Five Elements – Earth, Water, Fire, Air, Ether

In more scientific terminology = Solids, Liquids, Heat, Gases, Space

(B) Brahamana: Detailed description of each of the Five Elements and its Characteristics

(C) Aranyaka: Combination of elements and its characteristics and manifestations

(D) Upanishad : Aitareya – Describes the Manifestation of the Premordial Being – creation of the universe – sustenance and dissolution of the universe; Existence of Universal Consciousness

Yajur Veda - Rishi Vaishampayana : The Veda of Rituals

Yajur Veda is the only VEDA which has TWO prominent branches –

KRISHNA YAJUR VEDA – Rishi Vaishampayana

SHUKLA YAJUR VEDA - was directly revealed to Rishi Yagnavalkya

Yajur veda hymns and verses refer to the **procedures of performing different types of Worship**

- (a) Why a particular type of worship has to be performed
- (b) Who is qualified to perform
- (c) Who is qualified to chant the appropriate verses
- (d) What time and day of the year the worship has to be formed
- (e) What is the duration of the worship
- (f) What should be the layout of the worshiping area
- (g) What offerings have to be made



Yajur Veda:

(A) Samhita: Hymns related to the relation between being and Universe
In more scientific terminology = Micro and Macro Level – plant, animals, humans

(B) Brahmana: Detailed description on relation between various manifestations of the universe

(C) Aranyaka: Combination and its characteristics and manifestations

(D) Upanishad (Shukla):

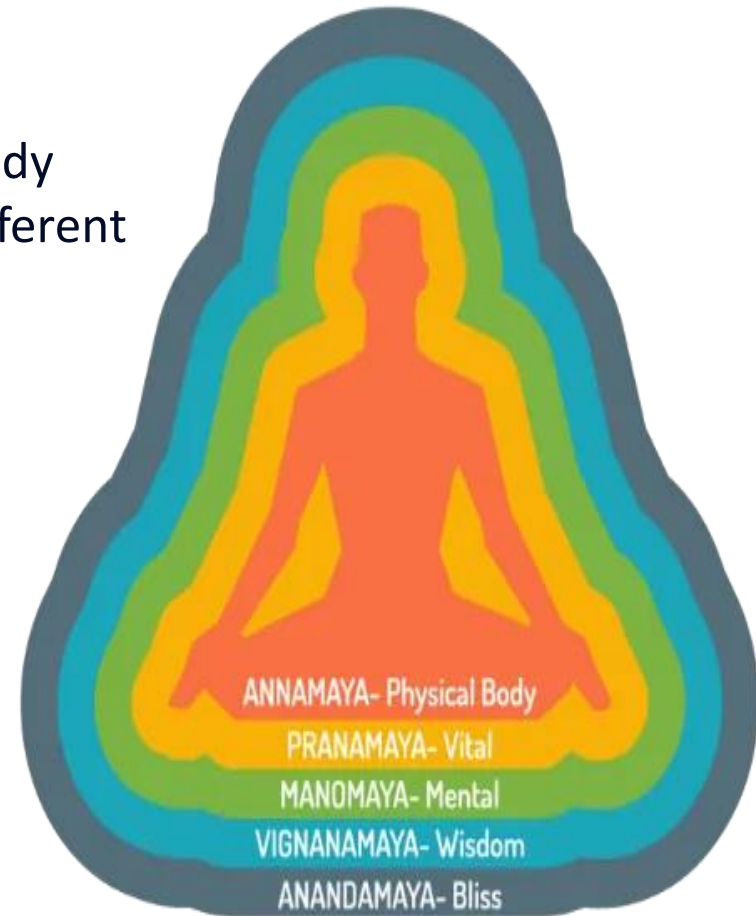
Isavasya – Structure is fundamentally the same, but it has allotropic forms. Example is: Carbon – Graphite, Graphene and Diamond. It is possible to convert graphite to diamond.

Brihadaranyaka – Compilation of question and answers – so that the students understand it better. Theme is the same – micro to macro level manifestation of the supreme being or universal consciousness.

(D) Upanishad (Krishna):

Taittiriya – Physical Body, Astral Body, Mind Body
Intellect Body and Self – how one can enter different
layers of this body.

Katopanishad – Conversation between a Child
and Sage – Is it possible to become
"DEATHLESS" can one live for ever....



Sama Veda – Rishi Jaimini : The Veda of melodies

- The Samaveda contains 1549 verses, except 75 verses taken from the Rigveda.
- This Veda is renowned as the foundation of Indian classical music and dance and serves as a treasury of melodious chants.
- It is important to note that the Samaveda Samhita is not intended to be read as a conventional text; rather, it is akin to a musical score sheet meant to be heard.
- It was specifically compiled for ritualistic purposes, with verses chanted during ceremonies

Sama Veda:

(A) Samhita: Hymns related to the explanation of the Universal Consciousness and how to connect with it by restraining the senses and the mind

(B) Brahamana: Detailed description on relation between mind and food and water and its influence on human body.

(C) Aranyaka: Combination and its characteristics and manifestations

(D) Upanishad : CHANDOGYA UPANISHAD

(i) Sleep: Rest, Dream, Deep Sleep

(ii) Conscious mind, sub-conscious mind and super conscious mind

(iii) Food, when eaten, becomes threefold: the grossest part becomes faeces; the middle part flesh and its subtlest part mind.

(iv) Water, when drunk, becomes threefold: Its grossest part becomes urine, its middle part blood and its subtlest part Prana.

(v) Fire (i.e., in oil, butter, fat.) when eaten becomes threefold: its grossest part becomes bone, its middle part marrow and its subtlest part speech. |

KENOPANISHAD

FIVE SENSE ORGANS – Eyes, Ears, Nose, Tongue and Skin

Control of the Mind on these sense organs

Conflict in the Mind : Truth and False / Right and Wrong

How to overcome Mind and Attain the state of Super Consciousness

Athara Veda – Rishi Sumantu: The Veda of Everyday life

- The Atharvaveda provides detailed guidance on the daily rituals and procedures of life.
- The Paippalada and Saunakiya are the two surviving recensions of the Atharvaveda.
- It deals with health, prosperity, practical wisdom
- More connected to common life than Rig, Sam and Yajur

Atharva Veda:

(A) Samhita: Hymns related to the process of enquiry, the seeker is curious to know the various aspects of the universe and its manifestations

(B) Brahamana: Details of how to enquiry, how to practice, nature of someone who is on the path of liberation;

(C) Aranyaka: Influence of external factors on internal growth of aspirants / seekers of truth

(D) Upanishad :

PRASHNA- Understanding of the Universe and the being and how they manifest through a process of Question and Answers;

MUNDAKA- Specifically for those who have chosen the path of renunciation; performing action with detachment

MANDUKYA – AUM is explained in detail, Sub-conscious, Conscious and Super-conscious states of mind – how it operates in sleep, deep sleep and dream state.

Key Takeaway

- Rigveda : Knowledge (Hymns, Philosophy)
- Samaveda: Music and Devotion (melody)
- Yajurveda: Ritual action (Procedure)
- Atharvaveda: Practical wisdom (Life, healing)

Together the Vedas = Theory (Rig) + Music/Arts (Sama) + Practical Manual (Yajur) + Applied Life science (Atharva)

They cover thought, sound, action and living – the complete spectrum of human and cosmic life

VEDANGAS – Essential Elements of Vedas

- Nirukta = Etymology, explanation of words
- Vyakarana = Grammar and linguistic analysis
- Chandas = Meter, the poetic meters, including those based on fixed number of syllables per verse, and those based on fixed number of morae per verse.
- Shiksha = Pronunciation phonetics, phonology.
- Kalpa = Ritual instructions
- Jyotishya = Right time for rituals and time keeping

**LOT OF EMPHASIS WAS GIVEN TO TIME-PLACE-
PRONUNCIATION-TEXT**

Vedangas

- **Shiksha** ("instruction, teaching"): phonetics, phonology, pronunciation. This auxiliary discipline has focused on the letters of the Sanskrit alphabet, accent, quantity, stress, melody and rules of euphonic combination of words during a Vedic recitation.
- **Chandas** ("metre"): This auxiliary discipline has focused on the poetic meters, including those based on fixed number of syllables per verse, and those based on fixed number of morae per verse.
- **Vyakarana** ("grammar"): grammar and linguistic analysis. This auxiliary discipline has focused on the rules of grammar and linguistic analysis to establish the exact form of words and sentences to properly express ideas.
- **Nirukta** ("etymology"): etymology, explanation of words, particularly those that are archaic and have ancient uses with unclear meaning. This auxiliary discipline has focused on linguistic analysis to help establish the proper meaning of the words, given the context they are used in.
- **Kalpa** ("proper. fit"): ritual instructions. This field focused on standardizing procedures for Vedic rituals, rites of passage rituals associated with major life events such as birth, wedding and death in family, as well as discussing the personal conduct and proper duties of an individual in different stages of his life.
- **Jyotisha** ("astrology"): Right time for rituals with the help of position of nakshatras and asterisms and astronomy. This auxiliary Vedic discipline focused on time keeping

Vedanta = Essence of the Vedas

If all the 4 vedas are put together then it will be several thousand pages; just as a full bible would be 2000 page and a full version of the Quran 600 pages and more.

Most people want the essence of these texts

(a) Are these texts relevant to us today ?

(b) How will it change my life today ?

(c) Why should I worry about it today?

Vedanta is the CONDENSED or ABRIDGED version of the VEDAS (all 4 vedas) –

Covering THE MOST ESSENTIAL ELEMENTS of the VEDAS; for some one who has limited time and wants some knowledge of the VEDAS, can ready VEDANTA.

Vedanta = Essence of the Vedas

- The word "Vedanta" is a combination of two Sanskrit words: "Veda", which means "knowledge" or "the whole corpus of vedic texts", and "anta", which means "end" or "the goal of".
- Vedanta can also be interpreted as "the ultimate knowledge of the Vedas" or "the end, conclusion, or finality of knowledge".
- Vedanta is a spiritual philosophy. It's based on the idea that our real nature is pure, immortal, and free, and that the purpose of life on Earth is to realize this divinity.
- Vedanta teaches methods to help people achieve this goal, and it's considered universal in its application, relevant to all cultures, countries, and religious backgrounds.
- Over time, Vedanta has branched off into three main streams: Advaita, Viśiṣṭādvaita, and Dvaita.

Philosophy of Jainism (700-600 BCE)

Jain= in Sanskrit = to conquer; in this context

“one who has conquered death” = NIRVANA or SALVATION

Jainism is 2600 years old, not a religion it is a practice.

Jainism was taught by tirthankaras

24 Tirthankaras : Rushabadeva to Mahavira (600 BCE)

Lord Mahavira spread it widely

After the MAHAPARI NIRVANA of MAHAVIRA , two separate schools of thought emerged

- (a) Svetambaras - Rituals, prayers, social welfare and spreading the teachings of the tirthankaras
- (b) Digambaras – absolute or complete renunciation - steadfast in understanding of the Self – which is the Supreme Self

Philosophy of Jainism (700-600 BCE)

Jainism teaches that every soul is divine and can become pure through right thinking, right knowledge, and right conduct.

Its based on (Ahimsa) and Main Teachings:

Ahimsa: Non Violence Don't harm any living being in thought, word or action.

Anekavedanta(Many sided truth): Truth can be seen in many ways.

Aparigraha (Non attachment) : Self-control, Avoid greed and Possessiveness

Karma and Moksha : Every action binds karma to the soul. Freedom (Moksha) comes when Karma is removed through right living.

Three Jewels

RIGHT FAITH: Believing in truth

RIGHT KNOWLEDGE: Understanding Reality correctly

RIGHT CONDUCT: Living ethically and with self discipline

Philosophy of Buddha (400-500 BCE)

Origin: Around 6th century BCE

Gautam Buddha born as Prince Siddhartha Gautama laid the foundation of Buddhism

Place: Bodh Gaya

Buddhism emphasizes on inner experience and meditation rather than blind belief.

Focuses on personal growth and universal harmony not just rituals



Philosophy of Buddha (400-500 BCE)

Philosophy of Buddha

Desire is the Cause for Suffering

Ignorance is the Cause for Desire

Four Noble Truth

There is suffering/ Desire

There is the cause of suffering/Desire

The cessation of suffering / Desire

The path to end the sufferings / Desire

Is Eight Fold Path

Right Understanding

Right Thought

Right Speech

Right Action

Right Livelihood

Right Attitude

Right Mindfulness

Right Concentration

Will lead to NIRVANA

Universal Human Values

- The purpose of his life upon earth is to follow the law (dharma) and achieve salvation (moksha) or freedom from his false self (ahamkara) by leading a balanced life in which both material comforts and human passions have their own place and legitimacy.
- The four aims are essential for the continuity of life upon earth and for the order and regularity of the world.
- They provide structure and meaning to human life and give us a reason to live with a sense of duty, moral obligation and responsibility
- Man cannot simply take birth on earth and start working for his salvation right away by means of just dharma alone.
- If that is so man would never realize why he would have to seek liberation in the first place. As he passes through the rigors of life and experiences the problem of human suffering, he learns to appreciate the value of liberation. He becomes sincere in his quest for salvation.
- So we have the four goals, instead of just one, whose pursuit provides us with an opportunity to learn important lessons and move forward on the spiritual path.

Universal Human Values embedded in the Vedic Tradition = PURUSHARTHA and STAGES OF LIFE:

Stage I : Is dominated by NEED, DESIRE, PASSION, = **KAMA**

Stage II : Is dominated by ACQUIRING, POSSESSION, FRIENDS,
RESPECT, STATUS IN SOCIETY = **ARTHA**

Stage III: Is dominated by SHARING, THANKS GIVING,
PHILANTHROPIC ACTIVITIES = **DHARMA**

Dharma = CODE OF CONDUCT = Truthful, Cleanliness, Well Behaved,
Forgiveness, No Hatred, No Jealousy

MOKSHA: Salvation, Nirvana, Liberation,

STAGE – I

F = Food

C = Clothing

S = Shelter

STAGE - II

F = Family

C = Career Growth

S = Society

STAGE - III

F = Fame

C = Contentment

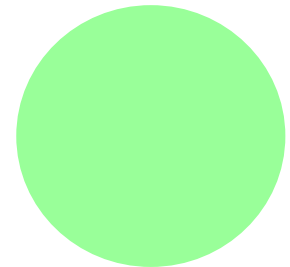
S = Spirituality & Salvation

SATTVA – RAJAS – TAMAS

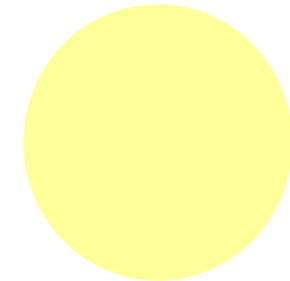
LET US DO A PERSONALITY ASSESSMENT EXERCISE

DOMINANT PERSONALITY

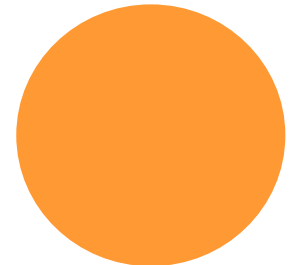
(A) How many of you like to play sports ? How many of you like to participate in dance / drama / such events ? I would like to be part of NCC ; I like adventure sports;



(B) How many of you like to read books ? Play Instruments ? Care for the plants, animals, senior citizens,

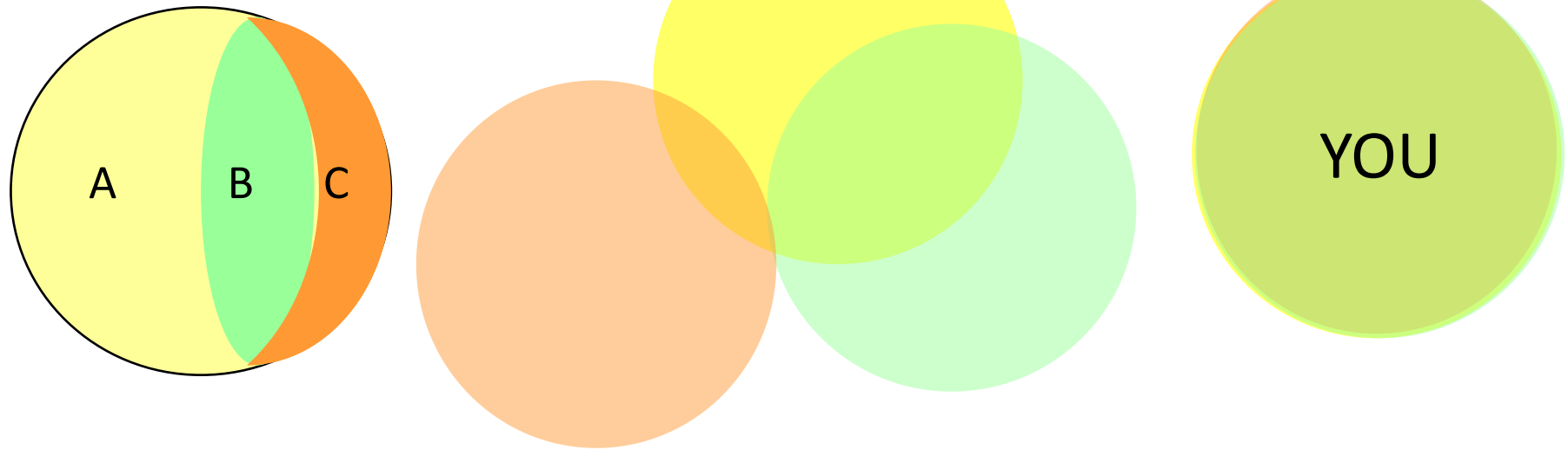


(C) How many of you like to chat on the mobile, chat and relax ? Be at home or with friends and do nothing?



COMBINATION OF PERSONALITY TRAITS MANIFEST BASED ON PLACE – TIME – PEOPLE AROUND US

50% of A – 30 % of B and 20 % of C



WHO DECIDES YOUR BEHAVIOUR OR THE PERSONALITY TRAITS

- MIND OR BRAIN ? DO WE KNOW THE DIFFERENCE ?
YOUR MIND IS ALWAYS WORKING, COMPARING, JUDGING, KEEP AN OPEN MIND !
- ENVIRONMENT - COLLEGE / HOME / WITH FRIENDS / IN FRONT OF PARENTS
- WATCH PEOPLE YOUNGER TO YOU; - YOU SAY HE/ SHE IS IMMATURE
- WATCH PEOPLE ELDER TO YOU – HOW YOU REACT -
TOO RIGID AND OLD STYLE OF THINKING

Mind is Subtle Matter – Science is yet to prove it –
if you demonstrate it – you will receive NOBEL PRIZE

YOUR MIND DETERMINES YOUR PERSONALITY

YOUR MIND HAS THREE BROAD COMPONENTS

- Sattva – Positive, Disciplined, Honest, Truthful, Sincere
- Rajas – Action, movement, speech, determined efforts
- Tamas - Lazy, Relaxed, No Motivation, Procrastinate, Ignorance, Greedy

COMBINATION OF

RAJAS AND TAMAS – cruel, hurt people, cowards, create fear among people, get angry easily;

RAJAS and SATTVA – brave, supportive, good administrators, musicians,

Tamas



Dull mind

Obscures Awareness

Veiling power

Apathetic, lazy,
sluggish, foggy,
heaviness, prone to
depression

Fear / Avoidance

Allows for rest and
sleep

Hinders Self-inquiry
& meditation

Sattva



Clear, calm mind

Reveals Awareness

Revealing power

Easy-going,
balanced, peaceful,
harmonious,
contented

Truth / Beingness

Allows for
discernment

Facilitates Self-inquiry
& meditation

Rajas



Energetic mind

Distorts Awareness

Projecting power

Busy, passionate,
aggressive, frustrated,
excited, prone to
anxiety

Desire / Anxiety

Allows for motivation

Hinders Self-inquiry
& meditation

At the fundamental level – there are two elements – matter & energy or matter (prakriti) and spirit (purusha)

So matter and energy manifest in different forms

- 100% Energy = pure consciousness
- Ego
- Intellect
- Mind – is Subtle Matter
- Five Sense Organs – Ear, Skin, Nose, Tongue, Eyes
- Five Organs of Action – Hands, Legs, Mouth, Excretory Organs
- 100 % matter – Earth (bones), Water (Blood), Air (Breath), Fire (Heat)

Magnetic field exists – but one cannot see it; or we have not yet developed the technique of seeing the magnetic field

A magnetic compass is essential to determine the direction of magnetic field

So also PURE CONSCIOUSNESS exists – we are unable to see it or experience it

